

Winning the first conversation

69 minutes including practice · 38 screens

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Your first-call reference

Use this after class alongside the presentation. Introduction, ALMS, channel choices, and examples are collected here. These fictional examples are adaptable wording, not scripts to recite.

The first conversation

Day 2 · Handling a Zillow Preferred lead with confidence

Learn the lead routes. Choose the right response. Guide the call with ALMS.

What we'll cover

Learn a piece, see an example, then try it.

- Recognize the leadWhat the buyer requested, how it arrived, and what needs confirming.
- Start the conversationLive connections, outbound calls, texts, and requested callbacks.
- Use ALMSAppointment, Location, Motivation, and Summarize - with questions that follow the buyer's answers.
- Put it togetherHandle common turns, complete the call, and follow through.

Help them take the next step

A request to see a home is interest in seeing it - not a promise to buy it.

Make meeting easy

Introduce yourself, help with the request, and offer a useful appointment early.

Understand the person

Learn what drew them to the home and why those details matter.

Earn the next conversation

Give helpful answers and a clear plan. Success can include a buyer choosing to wait.

Three lead routes

Read the lead's type and actual request before choosing your response.

Lead type	Buyer request	How it reaches you
Connection / contact agent	Contact about a home for sale	Live phone connection or FUB alert with contact preference

Lead type	Buyer request	How it reaches you
Real-time touring	A tour, using availability supplied through ShowingTime	FUB alert; not a live call in TRU's documented flow
Standard property tour	A tour at a requested time	Live connection or FUB alert; requested time may still need availability checks

Read what they actually sent

A few details tell you how to begin.

Request + property

Did they ask for information, agent contact, or a tour? Use the actual home and request in your opening.

Time + channel

Check the requested tour time, callback time, or “text me first” preference. Those are different instructions.

Buyer context

Use the timeframe and any supplied agreement answer. A question on an intake form does not tell you how this buyer answered.

A requested time, confirmed property access, and a completed showing are three different things.

A tour request still needs your help

Real-time touring supplies a stronger starting point for scheduling.

Real-time touring

The displayed slots draw on ShowingTime / MLS availability supplied by the seller or listing agent. Read the requested slot and verify the current arrangements.

Standard tour request

Where that availability is not integrated, a displayed time can be a buyer request rather than available access. Check before promising it.

Your response

Acknowledge the requested time. Tell the buyer what is confirmed and what you are checking. Do not make them start over.

Choose the response that fits

Calls help you hear tone, ask follow-up questions, and build a relationship.

Already connected live

Begin the conversation. You already have the buyer on the phone; no separate outbound call is needed.

New alert, no special preference

Call within five minutes of receiving it in TRU's normal 8 a.m.-8 p.m. operating window. Automation does not replace your call.

A stated preference

Honor text-first and requested callback instructions. An explicit "do not call" request is a boundary to respect.

If the first call is unanswered

Make it easy for the buyer to recognize you and respond.

- Call promptlyPlace the call within five minutes of receipt in the normal flow. Leave an opening voicemail when appropriate.
- Follow with a personal textConnect to the real inquiry and invite a phone conversation with genuine availability.
- Keep ownershipContinue useful outreach while unanswered. The automated introduction is separate from your work.

Hi Jordan, this is Sam with Northside Realty. I just tried calling about your request to see 1234 Lane. I can talk at 4 or 6 today - does either work for you?

"Text now" and "call at five"

Acknowledge the buyer now while respecting the plan they requested.

"Text is better right now."

"Of course. I can help here. A quick call would also let us talk through the home and your plans - would this evening work?" Text now; do not record a permanent no-call preference.

"Call me at five."

"Hi Maya, I'm Sam with Northside Realty, the agent who'll call at five about your request. Let me know if you have questions before then." Keep five unless the buyer agrees to change it.

"Please do not call me."

Honor that request. Give useful help through the agreed channel.

ALMS is your call framework

Start with a clear introduction. Then help with the appointment before discovery.

A

Appointment

Make it easy to meet.

L

Location

Understand where and what fits.

M

Motivation

Learn why it matters.

S

Summarize

Confirm what happens next.

Location and motivation can flow in either order. Listen to the person; do not recite a checklist.

Take the first turn

Orient the buyer: your name, brokerage, Zillow connection, and reason for the conversation.

Hi Jordan, I'm Sam with Northside Realty, a featured partner with Zillow. I'm reaching out about your request to see 1234 Lane.

Live connection

"Zillow connected us about your request..." fits a buyer already on the line. Begin warmly instead of waiting in silence.

Outbound call

"I'm calling about your request..." connects an unfamiliar number to something the buyer recognizes.

Use your real brokerage and role. Do not borrow claims about expertise or relationships that are not yours.

A • Appointment

Help with the reason they reached out before asking them to complete your process.

I saw you requested Saturday morning. Let me check that time with the property. If we need another option, would Saturday afternoon work?

When no time is requested

Offer two genuine options: "Would this afternoon or tomorrow morning work better?" Check property access before confirming.

Why it comes early

The buyer asked for help. An early invitation makes that help tangible; a long qualification interview can make the meeting feel conditional.

Ask for a few minutes

Explain why the questions will help the buyer.

Do you have a few minutes so I can learn what you're looking for and make our time together useful?

If they have time

Ask one question, listen, and use the answer to choose the next question.

If they are rushed

“Absolutely - let’s keep this quick.” Handle the appointment and essentials. Do not force the buyer through every question.

L · Location

Learn where the buyer wants to be - and what makes it work for them.

Start with their search

“What attracted you to this area?” or “Are there other areas you’re considering?”

Understand the connection

“What would make this location convenient for you?” Let the buyer explain the priorities.

Use what you already know

If they said they are moving from nearby, ask what is changing where they live now rather than repeating the intake form.

Location includes more than a ZIP code. Let the buyer define the places, routines, and tradeoffs that matter.

M · Motivation

Move from the feature to the reason behind it.

Buyer “We really want a bigger yard.”

Agent “What would you like to be able to do with that space?”

Buyer “I want room for a vegetable garden.”

Agent “That helps. What would the garden need from the space?”

“Big yard” is a feature. Gardening gives it meaning. Do not assume dogs, children, entertaining, or any other reason.

Stay with the answer

A conversation learns something. An interrogation just collects fields.

Acknowledge

Respond to what they said: “That makes sense - you want space you can actually use.”

Ask a relevant follow-up

“What is missing in your current place?” or “What would make the move worthwhile?”

Use the answer

Choose the next question or property comparison from that information. Warmth comes from attention, not a memorized joke.

Make the outing useful

Propose two or three homes so the buyer can compare and you can learn their preferences.

Since we’ll be out together, would it help to see a couple of other options? Now that I know the garden space matters, I can look for useful comparisons.

Explain the value

Comparisons help the buyer clarify what fits. They also give you options if one property becomes unavailable.

Respect the answer

Do not make extra homes a condition for seeing the original one. Be honest when an option differs from their criteria.

S • Summarize

Give the buyer back their priorities and the agreed next step.

You're looking in this area because it works for your commute, and usable garden space matters most. We're aiming for Saturday morning. I'll confirm access to 1234 Lane and send the details. You're open to two nearby comparisons. Have I understood that correctly?

Name what is agreed, what still needs checking, and who will do it. Invite the buyer to correct you.

Before you hang up

A good close removes uncertainty.

Appointment details

Restate the day, time, property or meeting location, and any access check still outstanding.

What they will receive

Explain the applicable touring form briefly and accurately. Confirm what you will send and when you will follow up.

What you will do

Research promised answers and comparisons. Save the buyer's priorities and agreed next action in FUB.

If a form or existing agreement raises a question you cannot resolve, call your team lead. Use the actual form's terms.

"I just have questions."

Help with the question; earn another invitation through useful service.

- Acknowledge and capture "Of course - what would you like to know?" Answer accurately; say what you need to check.
- Learn the context With permission, understand what drew them to the home and how the answer affects their search.
- Offer a useful next step Explain how seeing the home could help. If they still decline, stop pushing and agree how you'll bring back the answers.

Answers are not a reward for agreeing to a showing. Never guess or hide a known answer.

Keep the first meeting easy

Do not open with a demand for preapproval, budget, or proof they are ready to buy.

Why timing matters

They asked to see a home. A private financial interview from someone they do not know can turn that request into a barrier.

If the buyer asks

Answer their question. Learn enough context to make guidance useful; involve a lender for financing specifics.

The usual later opening

The end of the first showing offers context for a relevant financing conversation. A long buying timeline does not automatically rule out planning help.

“Are you the listing agent?”

Answer the role question clearly, then return to how you can help.

I'm not the listing agent. I help buyers, and I can coordinate with the listing side about this home. What would you like to know?

If they prefer the listing agent

Offer to help with that connection and ask whether a service check-in would be useful. Respect their decision.

Keep it accurate

Use your real role. Do not imply you represent the seller, invent a relationship, or launch into a full agency lecture.

“Is this home still available?”

If the home is under contract, give the truth and a useful next step.

- Prepare from their prioritiesUse what they told you to identify relevant alternatives.
- Explain what changedSay the home is under contract. Offer to check whether viewing or another option is still possible; do not promise it.
- Keep the next step usefulLearn what drew them to this home and offer a relevant option to explore together. Let the buyer decide.

Do not end the conversation with a bare “It’s under contract. Want something else?” Ask what mattered and explain what you can check.

Adapt to the person in front of you

The framework supports judgment.

“I have one minute.”

Keep it quick. Handle the appointment, explain the essential next steps, and respect the time constraint.

“I can’t visit soon.”

Learn the purchase drivers, criteria, and timing. Agree on useful updates and a communication plan instead of forcing a near-term showing.

“I’m not sure buying is right.”

Acknowledge the concern. Ask what is behind it, offer relevant education, and help them decide - even if the decision is to wait.

One call, from the opening...

Fictional demonstration · use your own words and true availability.

Introduce “Hi Jordan, I’m Sam with Northside Realty, a featured partner with Zillow. I’m calling about 1234 Lane.”

Appointment “Would Saturday morning or afternoon work better? I’ll verify access.”

Permission “Have you got a few minutes so I can make our outing useful?”

Location “What attracted you to this area?”

Jordan: “It would shorten my commute.”

...to a clear next step

The next question comes from what the buyer says.

Motivation “What else caught your eye?”

Jordan: “The yard. I’d like a vegetable garden.”

“What would you need from that space?”

Plan “Would you like to compare a couple of other homes while we’re out?”

Summarize “The commute and garden space matter. Saturday morning is your preference. I’ll check access, research the comparisons, and send the details. Is that right?”

Then briefly explain the applicable touring form and the follow-up you are actually committing to.

Follow through on what you promised

The next contact should have a reason the buyer recognizes.

Record the useful details

Save the request, location, motivation, communication preference, and agreed plan in FUB. Distinguish requested from confirmed.

Complete the promises

Get the property answer, check access, prepare the comparison, or send the agreed information. Set a task to remember it.

Make the next contact relevant

“I checked the garden space you asked about...” is more useful than an empty “Just checking in.” Use the agreed channel and timing.

If the new lead stays unanswered

Continue useful personal outreach; do not confuse automation with your effort.

Day one

Aim for three to four personal touches. The stated minimum is two calls and one personal text in the normal unanswered-lead flow.

First week

Aim for ten total touches, including day one. Most attempts should be calls; use relevant texts and vary contact times.

When they respond

Follow the conversation and agreed plan. Stop applying the unanswered-lead quota. An explicit contact restriction still governs.

If an engaged buyer later goes quiet, keep making thoughtful attempts. The stopping point is discretionary; there is no fixed new quota.

Keep this beside you

Introduction -> Appointment -> Location / Motivation -> Summarize

Before contact

Lead type · actual request · property · tour or callback time · contact preference

During the call

Orient them · offer the meeting · ask permission · follow an answer · propose useful comparisons

Before you finish

Restate priorities · distinguish confirmed from pending · explain the next step · record and follow through

Open your Day 2 reference and practice notes. Revisit any chapter whenever you need it.

Practice notes

Use fictional details. Write before the example, practice aloud, and retry one specific part after feedback. During a live session, submit through your own login; this printable worksheet is a backup and does not submit for you. Unfinished work remains available when the presenter advances.

Read the request

A standard tour lead asks for 5 p.m. The property's availability is not confirmed. What do you do?

- Acknowledge 5 p.m. and verify property access.
- Tell them the showing is confirmed because they selected 5 p.m.
- Ignore 5 p.m. and ask when they want to tour.

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Choose your next message

Maya's alert arrives at 2 p.m. and asks for a 5 p.m. call. Write your acknowledgment.

What would you text Maya now?

Now try the opening

Jordan asked to see 1234 Lane and has not requested a time. How would you begin?

- Introduce yourself and offer workable showing times.
- Start by asking for preapproval and budget.
- Explain the entire buying process first.

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Write your introduction and early appointment invitation.

Ask the next question

The buyer says, "We're already in town. We just need more space."

What would you ask next, and what would that help you understand?

Close this call

Jordan wants garden space, prefers Saturday morning, and is open to another home. Access is still unconfirmed.

Write the summary and next step you would say aloud.

Respond to their question

The buyer asks, "Should I talk to a lender before we look?" What is the best response?

- Understand their timing and concern, then offer relevant guidance.
- Say financing can never be discussed on the first call.
- Require a preapproval letter before continuing.

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Keep helping with the inquiry

On the first call, Jordan asks about a home that is under contract. You learn garden space matters. What do you say?

Write your response and a useful next step.

Your turn: handle the whole call

Jordan asked for a tour. Practice the call, then replay one part after feedback.

What did you learn about the buyer?

What will you improve?

What changed when you tried it again?

Observe the assigned learner and round:

- Clear name, brokerage, Zillow connection and purpose
- Useful early appointment invitation that respects the request
- Permission, relevant location/motivation questions and a follow-up
- Accurate priorities, commitments and unresolved checks
- Responds to the buyer's actual preference and circumstances

Observer / learner / round / one correction / retry:

Check your understanding

Without looking back, explain how you would handle the next lead.

What does ALMS stand for, and why does the appointment come early?

What changes when the buyer asks for a later call or text first?

Give one follow-up question that turns a feature into a reason.

Buyer practice cards

Jordan · a garden

I'd like to see 1234 Lane Saturday morning. I want room for a vegetable garden.

Buyer reveals the garden reason only after a relevant question. Agent confirms what still needs checking.

Maya · text first

I'm at work. Please text me now; I can talk at five.

Honor the current preference, acknowledge the request, and agree the later conversation.

Alex · questions first

I only wanted to know about the roof. I'm not ready to book a showing.

Help with the question, learn context with permission, and respect a declined invitation.

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References

- Your coach and approved team workflow.